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THAILAND — A LUXURY ESCAPE

JUNE – JULY · ONE MONTH · DIVE & DINE

- Bangkok
- Koh Samui
- Koh Tao
- Koh Phangan

Why this route: June/July is southwest monsoon on the Andaman coast (Phuket, Krabi, Similan Islands — officially closed 15 May–15 Oct, rough seas). The **Gulf of Thailand** (Samui, Phangan, Tao) runs the opposite cycle — sheltered, calmer seas. This trip stays Gulf-side, keeping weather risk close to zero.

Trip at a Glance

Week	Base	Focus	Vibe
Week 1	Bangkok	Arrival, luxury shopping, fine dining, temples	Glam city energy
Weeks 2–3	Koh Samui	5-star resort base, spa days, day-trip diving to Koh Tao	Slow luxury, beach club
Week 3 (mid)	Koh Tao	2–3 nights, dive-focused — moderate whale shark chance	Underwater adventure
Week 4	Koh Phangan & back to Samui	Quiet boutique stay, final shopping, spa, departure	Wind-down & polish

◆ Diving

Koh Tao — Gulf-sheltered water. Peak whale shark season is actually Mar–May (secondary window Sep–Oct); June/July is still diveable with occasional sightings, just a bit windier.

✦ Luxury & Shopping

Bangkok malls (Siam Paragon, ICONSIAM, EmQuartier — all open daily 10am–10pm) + Samui boutiques in Chaweng & Fisherman's Village.

✨ Food, No Seafood

Curries, stir-fries, noodles, and pineapple everywhere — coast-free Thai food is huge and easy to find.

Verified Logistics & Prices

Leg / Item	Time	Distance	Price (per person)
Flight: Bangkok → Koh Samui	~65–75 min	~475 km	~\$70–150 one-way
Ferry: Koh Samui → Koh Tao	~1.5–2 hrs	~68 km	~\$18–40
Ferry: Koh Samui → Koh Phangan	~30–45 min	~15 km	~\$6–9
PADI Open Water course (Koh Tao)	~3 days	—	~\$250–340 (9,000–12,000 THB)
Certified fun dive (per dive)	—	—	~\$28–50 (1,000–1,800 THB)
5-star resort, Koh Samui (e.g. Four Seasons)	per night	—	~\$1,200–3,500+

Bangkok Airways is the only nonstop carrier BKK ↔ Samui; ferry prices vary by operator/season. Figures checked against current listings as of Sep 2026 — always reconfirm close to travel dates.

A Taste of the Trip

- Massaman curry
- Khao soi
- ✨ Pineapple fried rice
- Mango sticky rice
- ✨ Pineapple shakes
- Grilled satay
- Som tam (no shrimp)
- Resort tasting menus, non-seafood on request

✕ No-seafood note: request non-seafood menus ahead at resorts — Thai food outside seafood is enormous and easy to enjoy everywhere on this route.

Quick-Glance Checklist

- ✦ Book Bangkok Airways early — it's the only nonstop BKK ↔ Samui carrier
- ✦ Confirm non-seafood menus with resorts ahead of arrival
- ✦ Pack for humidity + brief Gulf-side showers
- ✨ Check TMD (Thai Met Dept) updates closer to travel
- ✨ Stay Gulf-side only — skip Andaman/Similan this trip
- ✨ Reconfirm ferry schedules — they shift with season/operator

Made with you (and her) in mind ✨